Currency Conversion — Which Service Should We Use?

Plain-language note for Lead / Project Manager · Updated after Frankfurter v2 verification

What we need

Users enter an amount in Indian Rupees (INR) or another local currency. The product must convert it to US Dollars (USD), UAE Dirhams (AED), Saudi Riyals (SAR), etc., using the exchange rate for a **specific date** the user chooses. We should also **save the rate we used** on each record.

Reference & POC results

Reference pack: **22 Oct 2026**, **10,000 INR** ≈ **105.43 USD** / **388.90 AED**.

Frankfurter **v2** live check (API confirmed with lead):
`https://api.frankfurter.dev/v2/rates?base=INR&quotes=AED&date=2026-10-20`

Source	10,000 INR → USD	10,000 INR → AED	Notes
Reference (pack)	105.43	388.90	Target mid-market
Frankfurter v2 (2026-10-20)	105.40	387.20	Free · date works · SAR too
Frankfurter v2 (today sample)	~105.8	388.70	Close to reference AED

Services researched

1. **Frankfurter v2** — https://api.frankfurter.dev/v2/rates (free, no API key)
2. **Open Exchange Rates** — https://openexchangerates.org/
3. **ExchangeRate-API** — https://www.exchangerate-api.com/
4. **CurrencyAPI / community CDN** — demo only, not for production

Important: Older Frankfurter **v1** (ECB-only) did **not** include AED/SAR. That is why early testing looked incomplete. **v2** does include AED, SAR, USD, INR and date filters — confirmed in our POC.

Recommendation

Primary recommendation now: Frankfurter v2 (free) for our product conversion needs (INR → USD / AED / SAR, with a chosen date), unless the company requires a paid vendor SLA / commercial contract.

If we need a paid commercial vendor: Open Exchange Rates first; ExchangeRate-API if price is the main constraint.

Why Frankfurter v2 looks strongest for us right now

- **Free** — no API key, no monthly paid subscription for basic use.
- **Supports AED and SAR** on v2 (this was the earlier concern with v1).
- **Date-based rates** work with a simple query (as in the lead's sample URL).
- **Simple API** — easy to call from our Django server and save rate + date on each transaction.
- **Accuracy in POC** — AED/USD results were close to our reference pack.

Free vs paid (plain comparison)

	Frankfurter v2	Open Exchange Rates	ExchangeRate-API
Cost	Free (no key)	Free ~1,000/mo; paid for scale/history SLA	Free ~1,500/mo; paid for history/scale
AED / SAR	Yes (v2)	Yes	Yes
Past date	Yes (v2)	Stronger on paid	Paid for reliable history
Best role	Primary free option for our POC/product	Paid commercial backup / SLA	Paid budget alternate

Caveats to be aware of

Frankfurter is a free/community-style service (not a paid enterprise contract). If legal/procurement needs a paid SLA, uptime guarantee, or formal vendor agreement, keep **Open Exchange Rates** (or ExchangeRate-API) as the commercial path. For India statutory books, confirm whether **RBI / bank rates** are still required separately.

App status

Our POC app is wired to Frankfurter **v2** and successfully converts INR → USD / AED / SAR with a date. Open Exchange Rates and ExchangeRate-API remain available via a simple setting switch.

Decision asked: Approve Frankfurter v2 as the default conversion service for cost and fit. Keep Open Exchange Rates / ExchangeRate-API as paid alternatives if commercial SLA is required.

Free-plan numbers for paid vendors are approximate — re-check vendor sites before purchase. Internal review note.